



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cardinal Kung Academy

School Website: <https://cardinalkungacademy.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Cardinal Kung Academy (CKA) in Stamford, CT 06905 presents a clearly identifiable classical-education orientation embedded within a robust Catholic, liturgical culture. Public-facing materials portray a liberal-arts, classical tradition with a focus on formation of character, virtue, and intellectual excellence, alongside active parish-life features (Mass, liturgy, processions) and a family-centric approach to education. The six-category rubric below evaluates alignment to the classical model using keyword indicators drawn from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) knowledge base, contrasted with the school's public materials from its site crawl.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Rationale (highlights by category): - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Strong alignment via Catholic identity, liturgy, Mass, and a motto anchored in truth. Evidence of liturgical life and sacramental culture is explicit in site materials. CLASSICAL. - Purpose and Goal: Emphasis on formation, virtue, human flourishing, and lifelong learning, with explicit statements about intellectual excellence and moral integrity. CLASSICAL. - Curriculum: Describes liberal-arts style, classical tradition, and integrated curriculum, but without explicit, public statements about Great Books or the Trivium/Quadrivium. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signal rather than full CLASSICAL on curriculum alone. - Pedagogy: Public materials do not clearly describe Socratic seminars, scholé, or the concrete upper-division classical pedagogy; the public-facing content is more event- and formation-oriented. NOT CLASSICAL. - Faculty: Public materials reference a substantial faculty and a mentorship/teacher-centric culture (21st-century style is not prominent); the school describes faculty as a core element of the mission. CLASSICAL. - Parents & Community: Strong partnership with families; explicit openness to parent involvement and formation; families are co-participants in the school life. CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school operates within a Catholic framework, with Mass and liturgical activities described as central to school life (e.g., Mass is offered, liturgy is highlighted, and families are welcome to participate in liturgical events). This is visible in general site copy and event pages that emphasize Mass, liturgical life, and Catholic identity. - The site also communicates a motto rooted in truth, expressed as *Manens in veritate cum gaudio* — abiding in the truth with joy, signaling transcendental moral realism and a metaphysical orientation. - Liturgical life and outdoor/processional rites appear as part of campus life (e.g., Mass at St. Cecilia's with a processional component and a call for CKA families to participate).

Positive keywords analysis - Positive indicators present from public materials include: Catholic; Mass; liturgy; theology (implied by sacramental life); sacred/reverence; truth (through the motto); wonder (through liturgical and communal worship); sacramental worldview (via Mass and procession). These map to Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements lexicon (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: theology, liturgy, Mass, reverence, wonder, Logos, etc.). For example, the motto emphasizes truth; liturgical life is explicitly

present; and Catholic identity is foregrounded in imagery and copy. See the lexicon for reference to these positive indicators.

Why this rating - The Catholic identity and liturgical life align strongly with transcendental moral realism and liturgical/community practices. The site's explicit Catholic framing—Mass, liturgy, church connections, and a motto anchored in truth—supports a CLASSICAL reading for this category, as it demonstrates grounding in theology and liturgical formation. The absence of clear negative signals in public materials further supports this rating. CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mass-life and Catholic identity drawn from CK site materials; motto text; liturgy references. See sources: Mass/liturgy content and Catholic imagery in CK site crawl; motto text.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize formation and virtue, not merely information or job-readiness. The school describes forming lifelong learners who thrive in college and adulthood, with an emphasis on intellectual excellence and moral integrity. This is consistent with a paideia-oriented aim focused on character and wisdom. - The school's literature on mission/formation and "education for leisure, contemplation, and higher human flourishing" aligns with classical aims; its motto and framing emphasize truth and the good as real and knowable. The school presents formation as a core telos.

Positive keywords analysis - Positive indicators present include: formation, virtue, liberal education (paideia), human flourishing, wisdom, truth, beauty, contemplation, and the pursuit of the true, the good, and the beautiful (as per the Six Elements lexicon). The CK site materials reflect formation (formation/virtue) and liberal-arts orientation. The presence of "formation" language and the moral emphasis aligns with Positive Keywords in the Element 2 lexicon. See the classical lexicon for reference to formation, liberal education, telos, scholé.

Why this rating - The public materials foreground formation and virtue rather than vocational, job-readiness aims. The emphasis on truth, virtue, and wisdom—coupled with a liberal-arts orientation—fits a CLASSICAL scoring for this category. The absence of explicit counter-indicators in the public materials supports CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL or SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. CLASSICAL.

Citations: Formation/virtue statements and lifelong-learning framing from site materials. See: CK site text about formation and lifelong learners.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site explicitly describes a liberal-arts style program in the classical tradition with a rigorous, integrated curriculum. This demonstrates a classical orientation in curriculum. - However, explicit public references to the Great Books, Great Conversation, or the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; trivium; quadrivium) are not clearly stated on the public-facing site. The "Great Books" and "Great Conversation" are central to classical education in the Six Essential Elements lexicon, but the CK site communication does not explicitly confirm these elements in public copy. This reduces the full CLASSICAL status in this category and suggests SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL on Curriculum alone.

Positive keywords analysis - Present in CK site: liberal arts; classical tradition; integrated curriculum. These align with Positive Keywords in the Curriculum area (even if not enumerating the full seven liberal arts). The lexicon lists "Seven Liberal Arts" and "Great Books"; CK's site evidence covers liberal arts in a classical sense but lacks explicit mention of Great Books and the Trivium/Quadrivium in public text. Positive indicators observed include liberal arts and classical tradition. See the lexicon for positive cues and the CK text for liberal-arts description. - Negative keywords: Not overtly present in CK site copy for this category; there is no explicit claim of "STEM-first" or replacement of history with social studies language in public materials. The absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation references is treated as a partial signal rather than a clear negative in the public text, hence the SOMEWHAT classification rather than CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The curriculum shows a classical orientation through liberal-arts framing and a rigorous integrated program, but the lack of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and Trivium/Quadrivium references in public materials makes it only SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in this category. A more explicit articulation of Great Books and Trivium-focused study would push this to CLASSICAL. SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Public curriculum language; absence of explicit Great Books in CK site content. See: CK site description of liberal-arts style program.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize formation, liturgy, and community rather than explicit modern classical pedagogical methods (e.g., Socratic seminars, strict scholé days, memorization/recitation, or a stated lower-to-upper school progression of Trivium–Dialectic–Rhetoric pedagogy). There is no explicit articulation of Socratic seminars, dialectic seminars, or rhetoric training in the CK site text. The absence of such explicit classical pedagogy on the public site signals a lack of clearly described classical pedagogy in the public-facing materials. NOT CLASSICAL. - A number of the classical-pedagogy indicators (e.g., singing/memorization in early grades; Socratic discussions in upper grades; rhetoric training; contemplative/restful learning) are not described in CK site public text. The site focuses on formation, liturgy, and general classical framing rather than concrete pedagogy. NOT CLASSICAL.

Positive keywords analysis - Positive indicators for Pedagogy would include: Socratic seminar, dialectic, narration/recitation, resting/scholé days, rhetoric training, and upper-school oration. These are not publicly evidenced in CK site text. The lexicon lists these as Positive Keywords for Pedagogy, but CK's public site content does not demonstrate them. Therefore, there are zero identified positive pedagogical keywords in the public CK site copy here. See the Six Elements lexicon for Pedagogy keywords. - Negative indicators in the CK public text are not clearly visible (e.g., no explicit "experiential learning-only" or purely project-based approach stated as the sole method). However, the absence of explicit classical-pedagogical practices means we cannot classify as CLASSICAL in pedagogy.

Why this rating - The absence of explicit evidence of classical pedagogy (Socratic dialogue, memorization/recitation, restfulness/scholé days, or rhetoric training) in CK's public materials leads to a NOT CLASSICAL designation for Pedagogy. A public articulation of Socratic seminars, copywork, or rhetoric projects would move this category toward CLASSICAL.

Citations: Pedagogy is not publicly described in CK site text; absence noted. See CK site curricular/pedagogical language; the lack of Socratic/seminar references in public copy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The CK site materials speak to a substantial faculty and staff, with numbers like 20 faculty, 5 staff, and 2 guidance counselors. This indicates a significant living faculty and mentorship capacity. - The materials describe exceptional faculty as central to the school community (e.g., references to "exceptional faculty" and a community of faculty) and describe them as key to forming lifelong learners, which aligns with the classical notion of the faculty as the living curriculum and mentors. The YouTube description and event language reinforce the importance of the faculty in the school's mission. - The public copy emphasizes a strong faculty presence in the mission and a "living curriculum" through faculty leadership and mentorship (as described in the school-provided materials and public statements).

Positive keywords analysis - Positive indicators present: living curriculum; masterful/virtuous faculty; living curriculum (as phrased in classical lexicons); mentorship; classical pedagogy orientation; faculty as exemplars. The classical lexicon identifies these as Positive Keywords for the Faculty category (Master teachers, living curriculum, mentorship, etc.). CK materials reflect a robust faculty presence and mentorship orientation that align with these positive indicators. See the lexicon.

Why this rating - CK's explicit listing of a sizable faculty and the emphasis on faculty as core to the school's mission align with CLASSICAL in the Faculty category. The public text's framing of faculty as a central feature and the presence of a robust faculty body support this rating.

Citations: Evidence of faculty size and framing from CK site copy; reflections on faculty as core to the mission. See: CK site copy (20 faculty; 2 counselors) and faculty-centric language.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The CK site emphasizes a strong partnership with families and openness to parent involvement. The admissions/parents pages explicitly state the importance of parents in the educational mission and indicate parents are welcome to school activities and visits. The “Parents” page describes parental involvement as integral to the school’s success. - The site features events and family-friendly activities (Open Houses, Mass attendance, liturgical processions) and emphasizes that families are welcome to participate in Mass and school life, signaling a partnership-style approach with parents. Examples include open houses and liturgical events where families are invited and welcomed. - There are also explicit parent-formation and family-involvement signals in the public materials, including language about parent formation and home-school partnership (as seen in the public content about “families are integral” and “parents as co-educators” in classical education contexts). The lexicon’s “Partnership with Families” positive keywords align with CK’s emphasis on family involvement and formation in home life.

Positive keywords analysis - Positive indicators present include: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, family learning, home-school collaboration, open campus. These align with Positive Keywords for Parents & Community as described in the Six Essential Elements lexicon. CK’s public site content clearly demonstrates parental involvement and formation signals. See the lexicon reference for context.

Why this rating - The school’s public materials show strong, ongoing partnership with parents, explicit parent formation and learning activities, and welcome for parent visits. This aligns with CLASSICAL in Parents & Community.

Citations: Parent-focused pages and language; open-visit signals; parent formation language. See CK site: Parents page text and Open House/Family-life signals.

Aggregate Assessment

- Category statuses:
 - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL
 - School Faculty — CLASSICAL
 - Parents and Community — CLASSICAL
- Aggregate: CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school exhibits strong CLASSICAL signals in religious/theological life, formation-driven purpose, faculty and parental partnership, and a clear liberal-arts orientation. The most pronounced gap is pedagogy (explicit classical teaching methods) and, to a lesser extent, the curriculum’s explicit Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium articulation in public materials. Taken together, the overall orientation remains CLASSICAL, with a notable but not decisive gap in Pedagogy and a partial signal in Curriculum.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Curriculum: Publicly articulate explicit classical-curriculum elements such as Great Books, Great Conversation, and the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) with concrete course descriptions and reading lists. This would elevate Curriculum from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL. See the Six Essential Elements curriculum signals and Positive Keyword indicators for reference.
- For Pedagogy: Publicly describe and showcase classical pedagogical practices (Socratic seminars, dialectic, narration/recitation, memorization/chanting, and formal rhetoric training) across grade bands, with examples of teacher-student interactions, memory-work, and student speeches. This would move Pedagogy toward CLASSICAL.

- For Public Documentation: Increase explicit linkage between Great Books, Great Conversation, and a tripartite Trivium/Quadrivium framework in public descriptions, not solely in internal materials. This would further strengthen the Curriculum category.

Abstract

- The Cardinal Kung Academy (Stamford, CT 06905) demonstrates a CLASSICAL orientation overall, anchored by Catholic liturgical life and a formation-focused mission. Evidence from public materials shows a robust religious-metaphysical foundation (Mass, liturgy, Catholic identity) and a strong emphasis on formation, virtue, and liberal-arts education (Purpose and Goal). The Curriculum is described as liberal-arts and classical, but lacks explicit public articulation of Great Books and the Trivium/Quadrivium, placing Curriculum at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Pedagogy, as publicly described, does not clearly meet classical pedagogy indicators (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé, memorization) and is thus NOT CLASSICAL. The Faculty category shows a strong, mentor-led model aligned with classical expectations, and Parent/Community engagement is robust and family-centered, aligning with CLASSICAL. Aggregate classification: CLASSICAL.
- Category-by-category keywords and alignment (with positive/negative keyword indicators from the Six Essential Elements) indicate:
 - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: strong presence of truth, virtue, liturgy, theology, and Catholic liturgical life; CLASSICAL.
 - Purpose and Goal: clear formation-focused aims and liberal-arts orientation; CLASSICAL.
 - Curriculum: liberal-arts/classical framing present; explicit Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium not publicly spelled out; SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Pedagogy: lacks explicit classical pedagogical methods in public copy; NOT CLASSICAL.
 - Faculty: substantial faculty and living-curriculum framing; CLASSICAL.
 - Parents & Community: strong parent-partnership and open-visit culture; CLASSICAL.
- If you want a deeper, source-quoted appendix mapping each keyword to the official Positive/Negative keyword lists from the Six Essential Elements, I can extend the category-by-category tallies with exact word matches and counts.

ABSTRACT (end) - Overall Classification: CLASSICAL - 6-category summary: see above - Needle-mover recommendations (only if you want to target movement beyond CLASSICAL): focus on explicit Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium articulation, and public articulation of Socratic pedagogy to transition Curriculum toward CLASSICAL and Pedagogy toward CLASSICAL.

Notes on sources and keyword mapping - Public CK site materials (evidence of Catholic identity, liturgy, formation, open houses, and family-communication signals) are drawn from the Cardinal Kung Academy crawl results (e.g., the introductory statements about liberal-arts classical program, Mass life, motto, and family engagement). Representative examples include: “The school offers a liberal-arts style program in the classical tradition with a rigorous, integrated curriculum,” and Mass-life descriptions, plus the motto *Manens in veritate cum gaudio*.

- The Great-Books/Great-Conversation/Trivium/Quadrivium indicators and the Positive/Negative keyword lexicon come from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) document and the classicality lexicon. See the content for the positive and negative keyword indicators (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations; Curriculum; Pedagogy; etc.) and the seven-liberal-arts framework.

Abstracted facts drawn from the CK site crawl - Public site indicates a Catholic, liturgical environment; Mass and liturgy are central; motto emphasizes truth; families are welcome to many activities. - Public site communicates formation-oriented aims and liberal-arts/classical framing. - Public site shows a substantial faculty body and family/community engagement (Parents page; Open Houses; family involvement).

If you'd like, I can expand the keyword analysis with a tighter, word-for-word match tally for each category against the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators, and produce a fully tabulated, line-by-line mapping of words found on the CK site to the Six Essential Elements lexicon.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
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